eclectic

WEEKLY TRENDS
FOR SPC GLOBAL
ISSUE 3

WHAT ARE WE SEEING AROUND THE WORLD THIS WEEK?

Coke makes gut health mainstream.

Coca-Cola launched Simply Pop, its first prebiotic soda, and went straight at Olipop and Poppi. Protein kept spreading too: Starbucks and Arla put it in RTD coffee, David Protein moved from bars into milkshakes, and Vimto owner Nichols launched a clear whey water. There is a warning sign as well, with shoppers starting to tire of protein in everything, including coconut water.

Week of 26 October–1 November 2026

170 SIGNALS TRACKED

13 MARKETS

30 PACK & DESIGN IDEAS

Alli & Kahn
Eclectic innovation team

Act on this now

GUT HEALTH · US

Coca-Cola enters prebiotic soda with Simply Pop

Simply Pop is Coca-Cola's first prebiotic, gut-health soda, launched in three flagship flavours and aimed directly at Olipop and Poppi.

Why it matters: Gut-health soda now has the world's biggest drinks company behind it. Any better-for-you soft drink or sparkling coconut water from SPC will be judged against Coke's pitch and price.

Food Dive · Read the story

PROTEIN COFFEE · GLOBAL

Starbucks and Arla launch a high-protein RTD coffee range

Starbucks has partnered with Arla on a ready-to-drink high-protein coffee line that is now reaching retail shelves.

Why it matters: Protein is becoming the expected upgrade in RTD coffee. Any SPC coffee or dairy drink on the shelf next year will be compared with it.

FoodBev · Read the story

AUSTRALIA · AUSTRALIA

Coles slips behind Woolworths as cost-of-living pressure bites

Woolworths posted $19.4bn in quarterly sales, up 4.7% on its value push. Coles' sales growth lagged, even with e-commerce up 22.9%.

Why it matters: Value is winning the Australian shelf right now. Take a clear price and pack-size story into every range review for Casa Coco, Stacked and Juice Lab.

Inside FMCG · Read the story

Beverages & coconut water

COCONUT WATER · BEVNET

CocoLove expands distribution and widens its coconut water range

The chocolate coconut water brand is moving into new markets and adding flavours.

Why it matters: Coconut water innovation is moving into flavour, not just plain water. A direct read for Casa Coco's next range.

BevNET · Read the story

SOCIAL · SPORKED

Shoppers push back on Aldi's protein coconut water

Sporked reports shoppers reacting with fatigue to Aldi's latest protein product, a protein-fortified coconut water.

Why it matters: Protein plus coconut water is getting crowded and shoppers are noticing. Stacked and Casa Coco need taste and a clear reason to buy, not just a protein number.

Sporked · Read the story

PROTEIN WATER · NUTRITIONINSIGHT

Vimto owner Nichols and Myprotein launch a clear whey protein water

Nichols has partnered with THG's Myprotein on a clear whey protein water for the UK market.

Why it matters: Another mainstream soft drink company has moved into clear protein water. The format Stacked plays in keeps attracting big names.

NutritionInsight · Read the story

KIDS · BEVERAGEDAILY

Kraft Heinz, Gerber and Once Upon a Farm all push into kids' hydration

Capri-Sun Hydrate, Gerberlyte and Once Upon a Farm's electrolyte pouches all launched within weeks of each other.

Why it matters: Kids' hydration is opening up as its own occasion. Coconut water is a natural fit for a lunchbox-size Casa Coco.

BeverageDaily · Read the story

Protein, dairy & yoghurt

PROTEIN DRINKS · BEVNET

David Protein moves into RTD milkshakes, backed by a US$250m raise

The protein bar brand has launched RTD protein milkshakes. Parent company Medici Brands raised a US$250m Series B to fund the push into drinks.

Why it matters: Serious money is flowing into RTD protein, and snack brands are now drinks competitors too.

BevNET · Read the story

YOGHURT · FOODBEV

Müller and Myprotein lift their co-branded yoghurt to 20g protein per pot

The UK's biggest dairy brand is deepening its sports-nutrition range with a 20g protein pot.

Why it matters: Protein yoghurt is fully mainstream in the UK, and 20g is becoming the number to beat.

FoodBev · Read the story

DAIRY DRINKS · DAIRYREPORTER

Dairy drinks are well placed to ride the 'benefit stacking' trend

DairyReporter argues dairy drinks can carry protein, gut health and other functional claims in a single product.

Why it matters: A useful frame for SPC's dairy drink pipeline: one product, several reasons to buy.

DairyReporter · Read the story

Retail & rules

M&S · TREND HUNTER

M&S Foodhalls take a functional soda range built on four moods

M&S is ranging this.is.gspot functional soft drinks, built around Lift, Soothe, Protect and Awaken, with botanicals, adaptogens and nootropics.

Why it matters: A premium UK grocer is giving functional soda a home in the main range. Plain, benefit-led naming is worth noting for any SPC functional drink.

Trend Hunter · Read the story

REGULATION · FOOD DIVE

Danone joins Nestlé and Coca-Cola in rewriting recycling labels

Danone is revising on-pack recyclability claims after an EU greenwashing complaint, following Nestlé and Coca-Cola.

Why it matters: Recycling claims are under real scrutiny. Check every SPC pack claim is one you can prove.

Food Dive · Read the story

Pay homage to: pack & design

REFRESH · THE DIELINE

GoodPop's pack refresh is credited with lifting sales

The Dieline reports GoodPop's redesign has been directly linked to stronger retail sales.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it when building the business case for refreshing an SPC brand: tie the new design to sales goals from day one.

The Dieline · Read the story

PROTEIN PACK · THE DIELINE

Stack's protein packaging skips the gym-bro clichés

A protein drink pack that avoids hardcore gym cues for something more playful and welcoming.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to its friendly, approachable look so Stacked feels like an everyday drink rather than a gym product. (Stack is a different brand from Stacked.)

The Dieline · Read the story

TRENDS · THE DIELINE

Dieline's 2026 trend report: 'Clinical with Soul' and 'Soft Edges'

Science-forward wellness design softened with warm serifs and gradients, plus rounded pack shapes, lead the 2026 themes.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to 'Clinical with Soul' on Juice Lab shots: science-led claims, softened with warm type and gradients.

The Dieline · Read the story

Opportunity of the week

8 /10

Nam Hom Reserve: the fragrant coconut water

$5.50 · 350ml / $10 · 1L

A super-premium, single-variety Thai Nam Hom ('fragrant') coconut water, HPP and sold chilled only. Pure, plus a naturally blushing Pink limited batch. For coconut water lovers who will pay more for taste, not functions.

Vita Coco paid up to US$275m for Copra, a cold-chain super-premium coconut water maker growing 48% a year. A chilled top tier lifts dollar value in a category buyers already rate, and gets Casa Coco ahead of Copra reaching Australia.

Pack idea: A clear bottle with a folk-art illustrated label for each batch, so it feels collectible and crafted rather than another tropical cliché.

DEMAND	8
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Your Eclectic innovation team
Alli Bailey & Kahn Vocale

Want us to go deeper on anything here? Reply to this email and we'll run a full category brief.

Alli · **alli@eclecticgroup.com.au** · 0488 864 779
Kahn · **kahn@eclecticgroup.com.au** · 0417 880 877

Do the homework, then commit and go hard.

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Eclectic Group · Level 4, 691 Burke Rd, Camberwell VIC 3124